Lifetime of HelloWorld Program

CSE 2138: Systems Programming

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Hello World Program in C

```
#include <stdio.h>

int main(){
        printf("Hello World! \n");

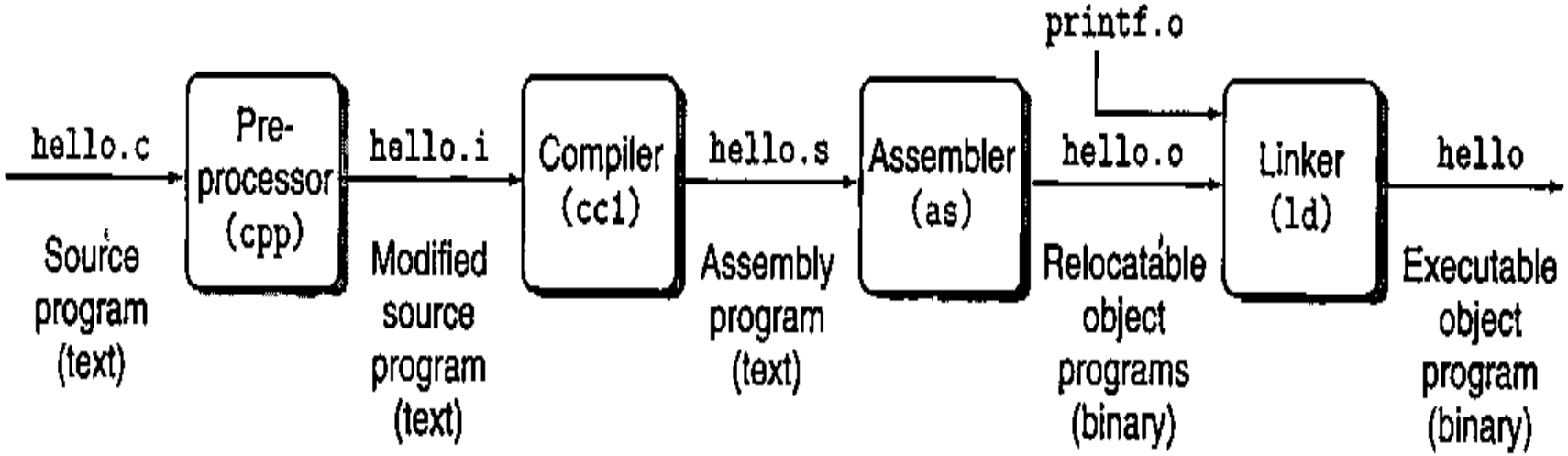
        return 0;
}
```

The program → *hello.c*

#	i	n	c	l	u	d	e	*SP*	<	s	t	d	i	o	.
35	105	110	99	108	117	100	101	32	60	115	116	100	105	111	46
h	>	\n	\n	i	n	t	*SP*	m	a	i	n	(	)	\n	{
104	62	10	10	105	110	116	32	109	97	105	110	40	41	10	123
\n	*SP*	*SP*	*SP*	*SP*	p	r	i	n	t	f	(	"	h	e	l
10	32	32	32	32	112	114	105	110	116	102	40	34	104	101	108
l	o	,	*SP*	w	o	r	l	d	\	n	"	)	;	\n	*SP*
108	111	44	32	119	111	114	108	100	92	110	34	41	59	10	32
SP	*SP*	*SP*	r	e	t	u	r	n	*SP*	0	;	\n	}	\n	
32	32	32	114	101	116	117	114	110	32	48	59	10	125	10	

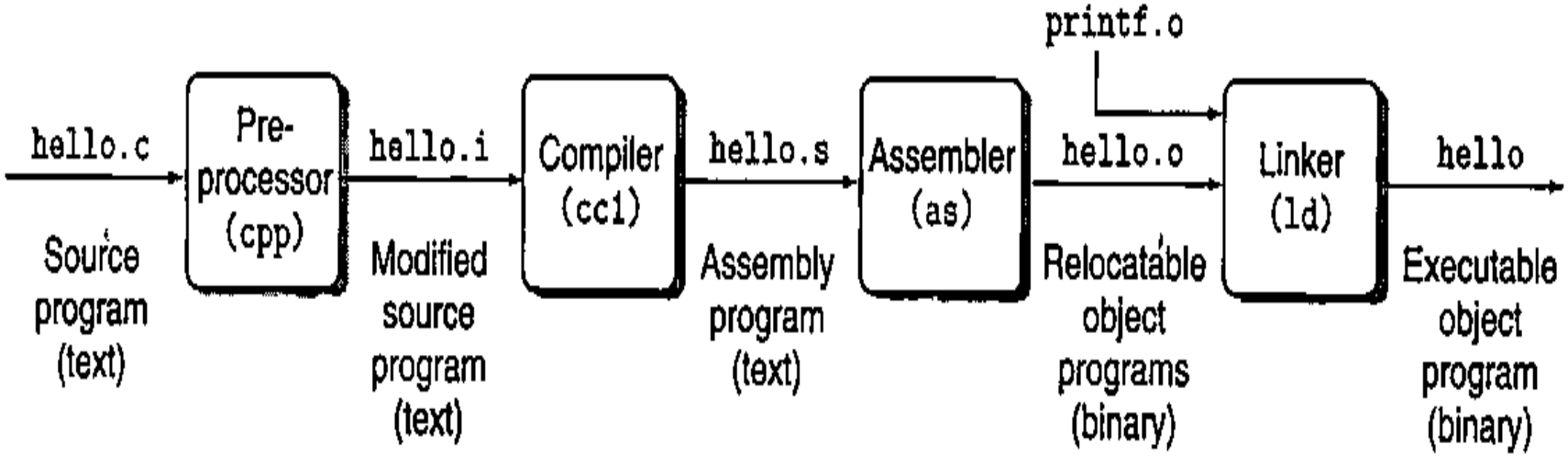
The ASCII text representation of *hello.c*

The Compilation System



- The gcc compiler driver reads source file "*hello.c*" and translates it into an executable object file "*hello*"
- The translation is performed in the sequence of four phases
  - preprocessor,
  - compiler,
  - assembler, and
  - linker

The Compilation System



- **Preprocessing phase**
  - The preprocessor (cpp) modifies the original C program according to directives that begin with the '#' character.
  - For example, the **`#include <stdio.h>`** command in line 1 of *hello.c* tells the pre-processor to
    - read the contents of the system header file *stdio.h* and
    - insert it directly into the program text.
    - The result is another C program, typically with the *.i* suffix → *hello.i*

The Compilation System

Compilation phase

- The compiler (cc1) translates the text file *hello.i* into the text file *hello.s*, which contains an *assembly-language program* → *hello.s*

- This program includes the definition of function main

- Each of lines 2-7 in definition describes one low-level machine-language instruction in a textual form.

```
1    main:
2      subq    $8, %rsp
3      movl    $.LC0, %edi
4      call    puts
5      movl    $0, %eax
6      addq    $8, %rsp
7      ret
```

- Assembly language is useful because it provides a common output language for different compilers for different high-level languages.

- For example, C compilers and Fortran compilers both generate output files in the same assembly language.

The Compilation System

- **Assembly phase**
  - Next, the assembler (as)
    - translates *hello.s* into machine language instructions,
    - packages them in a form known as a *relocatable object program,* and
    - stores the result in the object file *hello.o*.
  - This file is a binary file containing bytes to encode the instructions for function main.
  - If we want to view *hello.o* with a text editor, it would appear to be nonsense.

The Compilation System

- **Linking phase**
  - Notice that our hello program calls the **`printf`** function, which is part of the *standard C library* provided by every C compiler.
  - The **`printf`** function resides in a separate precompiled object file called *printf.o*, which must somehow be merged with our *hello.o* program.
  - The linker (ld) handles this merging.
  - The result is the *hello* file, which is an executable object file (or simply *executable)* that is ready to be loaded into memory and executed by the system.